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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION

NOVEMBER 2025 FIRST SEMESTER

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG1MDCJMC100 - BASICS OF PHOTOGRAPHY

(2024 ADMISION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions. Answer all questions . Each question carries 1 marks

1. In what year was the first color photograph produced?

    a). 1861

2. Name of the first photograph ever taken

    a). A View From The Window at Le Gras

3. Identify the primary function of the camera obscura.

    c). To project an image onto a surface

4. Who invented tintypes?

    a). Adolphe-Alexandre Martin

5. What is one of the primary goals of product photography?

    b). To showcase the product clearly and attractively

6. What is one key ethical practice in photojournalism?

    d). Authentic representation of reality

7. Which lens is most commonly used in landscape photography?

    c). Wide-angle Lens

8. Identify the primary function of a tripod in photography

    b). To stabilize the camera for long exposures

9. Name which component allows manual adjustment of focus in a still camera

    a). Focus ring

10. Identify how does the camera's ISO setting affect the image.

b). It affects the brightness or sensitivity to light

11. Which of the following shutter speeds lets in the most light?

d). 1 second

12. Explain if you want to capture motion blur, which setting should you adjust?

c). Widen the aperture

13. What is a practical method for organizing people in a large group photo?

b). Keep all members roughly equidistant from the camera

14. What is the primary function of a color gel in lighting?

b). To change or correct the color of the light

15. Placing the horizon on the lower third of the frame using the rule of thirds is often used for

a). Emphasizing the sky

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions . Answer any 5 questions. Each qn carries 3 marks

16. Define what is meant by 'point-and-shoot' in the context of photography.

A point-and-shoot camera is a simple, compact camera designed for ease of use, featuring automatic exposure settings and often a fixed or limited zoom lens. The term refers to the minimal effort required—the photographer simply points the camera at the subject and shoots the photo without manually adjusting settings.

17. Estimate the significance of the Leica camera in the early 20th century.

The Leica camera, introduced in 1925, was profoundly significant as it popularized the use of 35mm film (previously used for cinema) in still photography. Its compact size and superior optics ushered in an era of photojournalism and candid photography, enabling photographers to capture action and everyday life more discreetly.

18. List the key differences between Polaroid cameras and digital cameras.

Polaroid cameras produce an instant physical print directly after the shutter is pressed and use chemical film cartridges. Digital cameras capture and store images electronically on a memory card, allowing for instant review and deletion without producing a physical print immediately.

19. Classify the scenarios where adjusting the white balance is necessary

Adjusting the white balance is necessary whenever the scene is lit by a non-daylight light source, such as tungsten bulbs, fluorescent tubes, or mixed lighting conditions. These different light sources cast color casts that the camera must correct to render colors accurately and make white objects appear genuinely white.

20. Explain how the sensor in a camera impacts image quality.

The camera sensor (either CCD or CMOS) captures the light and converts it into a digital image; its size directly affects image quality, with larger sensors generally capturing more light and detail. Additionally, the sensor's resolution (megapixels) and its ability to handle low light (noise performance) are crucial determinants of the final photograph's quality.

21. Describe the optical viewfinder mechanism in SLR cameras.

In a Single-Lens Reflex (SLR) camera, the optical viewfinder uses a system of mirrors (including a movable reflex mirror) and a pentaprism to reflect the exact image that passes through the lens up to the photographer's eye. This mechanism allows the photographer to see precisely what the lens is seeing, enabling accurate framing and focusing.

22. Importance of White Balance.

White balance is crucial for color accuracy because it ensures that colors captured by the camera look natural and true to life, regardless of the light source. Correct white balance removes undesirable color casts (e.g., blue from shade, orange from indoor lighting) and makes the image more visually appealing and realistic.

23. What materials are barndoors usually made of?

Barndoors are lighting modifiers typically made of metal (such as aluminum) or occasionally a durable, heat-resistant plastic when used with lower-powered lights. This choice of material is necessary to withstand the high heat generated by powerful professional studio light fixtures.

Part C

Essay Type Questions . Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 10 marks

24. Describe the kinds of photography that professionals and amateurs explore?

Amateurs often explore broad genres like landscape, portrait, and travel photography as hobbies, focusing on personal subjects and fundamental techniques. Professionals, conversely, often specialize in high-demand, commercial niches such as photojournalism, fashion, product (commercial), wildlife, under water, sports, or wedding photography. While both groups can overlap in any genre, professionals typically pursue genres that require specialized equipment and a consistent income stream.

25. Discuss the evolution of camera technology from film to digital, highlighting the key innovations.

The evolution shifted from chemical processing of light-sensitive film to electronic capture using sensors. The key innovations were the invention of the Charge-Coupled Device (CCD) and later CMOS image sensors that replaced film, and the introduction of memory cards and LCD screens for instant image viewing and storage. This transition offered convenience, immediate feedback, and lower per-shot costs, fundamentally democratizing photography.

26. . Explain the importance of choosing the right lens for different photography genres, such as portraits, landscapes, and sports.

Choosing the right lens is vital as it determines the angle of view, magnification, and depth of field, all of which define the visual style of a genre. For portraits, a medium telephoto lens (e.g., 85mm) with a wide aperture is chosen to flatten facial features and create a shallow depth of field (bokeh). In contrast, landscapes rely on wide-angle lenses (e.g.16mm) to capture a vast field of view

and achieve deep focus, while sports demand long telephoto lenses (e.g.,400 mm) and wide apertures to isolate distant action and freeze fast movement.

27. Analyze the combined impact of composition rules, lighting setups, and aperture control on the aesthetic quality of cinematic shots.

These elements work synergistically to convey mood and narrative: Composition rules (like the Rule of Thirds or symmetry) guide the viewer's eye and establish the emotional balance of the frame. The lighting setup (e.g., three-point or low-key) dictates the atmosphere and texture, creating shadows that add drama or depth. Finally, aperture control manages the depth of field, isolating the subject with a shallow focus to create emotional intimacy or keeping the entire scene sharp for contextual clarity.